

IMT 542 Assignment G4:

Define and present initial information story for product

Em Stelter, 4/22/2026

1) Description of information system

Description of information system product:

- Archive of Our Own, or Ao3, is an online archive of fanfiction (i.e. stories or other kinds of art about / set in a preexisting intellectual property, written by fans for free, purely for the love of the game) and other transformative works. Fanfiction as a writing genre, particularly as stored on Ao3, differs from traditional fiction in that stories are heavily tagged with metadata that flags information about the story up front, including certain types of character relationships, content warnings, ratings, among other things.
- The product is a Python-based program that scrapes metadata from published works on the fanfiction archive website Archive of Our Own (Ao3). The product will compile a table of metadata for all works listed under a particular fandom or intellectual property on Ao3, then builds an interactive dashboard of the fandom's collective metadata to provide insights about the cultural impact of the IP seen by the subject matter of fan writers' works.
- The product would be applicable to any fandom / particular intellectual property with a fandom presence on Archive of Our Own.

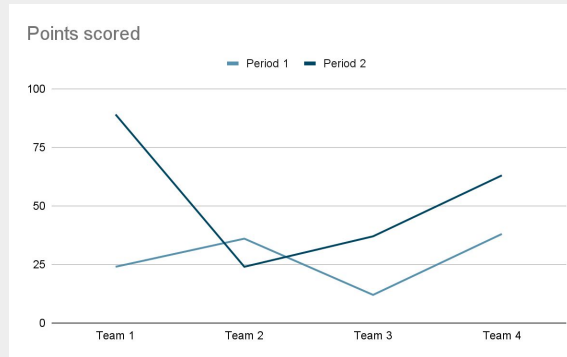
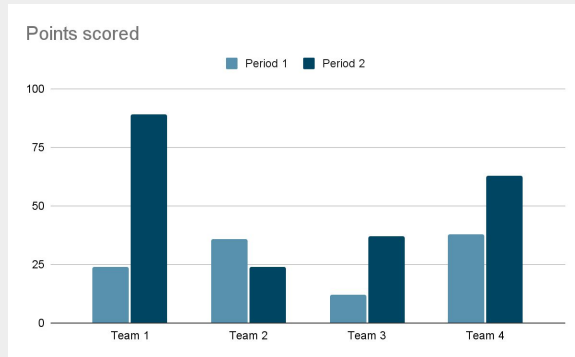
Comparison to existing systems:

- Currently, there is one particular Ao3 user who reports on fandom metadata statistics (and provides tutorials of downloading fandom metadata directly from Ao3), but these reports not presented in an interactive dashboard. I would be writing a developing a program/process that would allow for scraping fandom metadata and then publishing it in an interactive dashboard format.
- Relevant links:
 - <https://archiveofourown.org/works/27804601/chapters/122214766>
 - <https://archiveofourown.org/works/62863873>

2) Information Wireframes

Slide 2*: information wireframes (blueprint of how information is organization and/or UI wireframes that suggest how information is organized)

Candela Obscura Fandom Statistics



Insights notes on visualizations

3) Description of Main Concepts

Slide 3*: description of main concepts that ideally will be in the information product as either controlled vocab list or metadata scheme/taxonomy

- Content Metadata:
 - **Fandom** - the specific IP that the fanworks are based on
 - **Rating** - analogous to film ratings, goes from G (General / All Ages) to E (Explicit)
 - **Archive Warning** - specific content warnings for things like Major Character Death, Graphic Violence, etc.
 - **Category** -
 - **Relationship(s)** - relationships between characters (romantic, platonic, familial, etc.)
 - **Freeform / Additional Tags** - any metadata tags that don't belong to the standard content categories but are repeated
- Publication Stats:
 - **Date Published** - date the fanwork was published
 - **# Chapters** - self-explanatory
 - **Completed (Y/N)** - whether the work is an ongoing / serialized story or a completed work
 - **Date Updated** - publication date of most recent chapter (useful for fics that are not completed)
 - Word Count
 - **Kudos** - akin to a "like" button
 - **Comments** - specific reader feedback beyond kudos
 - **Bookmarks** - whether other Ao3 account holders have saved / bookmarked the work in their account
 - **Hits** - number of clicks on the fanwork's webpage

4) Basic System Architecture

Identifying basic architecture for system (hosting, information structure, technologies) as best as you can today

- Technologies:
 - Incorporates Ao3downloader: <https://github.com/nianeyna/ao3downloader> for fanwork metadata scraping
 - Data analysis & dashboard code developed using Python (specifically Streamlit library)
- Hosting:
 - Code housed in public Github repository
 - Sample dashboard published on Streamlit Community Cloud
- Documentation:
 - Github ReadMe describing data cleaning, analysis & dashboarding process
 - Zine description of overall process for developing the tool / recommended / suggested uses for resulting dashboards (this is an excuse for me to make a zine, but also a format of sharing information that aligns closely with common fandom / DIY creative space values)